

accepts your rent anyway, the landlord is not allowed to kick you out for violating the provision. For example, if your lease forbids overnight guests, but your landlord knows you have one and accepts your rent check anyway, he cannot evict you later on this basis.

- » In most cities, if you provide written notice of major problems such as glitches with heating, electricity, and plumbing, your landlord is required to fix them. Your landlord is not always responsible, however, for taking care of minor problems like leaky faucets or worn-out floors. Check your lease to see what repairs the landlord is responsible for and check the landlord-tenant rules in your city.
- » In some states you can withhold rent if there's been negligence on the part of the landlord, but the rules are very specific about how to do this. Again, call or visit the website of your county or state housing office or office of consumer affairs to find out the rules in your area.

For additional information on your rights as a tenant, try contacting local branches of the Legal Aid Society or your state attorney general's office. Nolo.com is a useful website that provides links to renters' rights sites all over the country.

## ↓ **SHOULD YOU RENT OR BUY?**

Many people believe that given the choice, renting is a bad idea: They think it's the equivalent of "throwing money away." But when you're young, it's often smarter to rent than to buy. I know many people who purchased a studio apartment soon after college and then two or three years later got married and had to sell their place at a loss.